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John Strand - Webcast: AI and Pen Testing- ... Are we cooked?



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Hey everybody, it's [John Strand](#) !

There has been a lot of discussion lately about AI and what it means for penetration testing. Depending on who you talk to, AI is either going to replace every pentester on the planet or completely revolutionize the way we work. As usual, the reality is somewhere in the middle. But catastrophizing is good marketing.

In this webcast, I want to talk about what we're actually seeing in the field at **Black Hills Information Security** (BHIS). We'll discuss how AI is changing penetration testing, how we're using it internally, what we're hearing from customers, and why so many people across the industry are concerned about what comes next. Because... Yeah... "concern" is warranted.

Thu, Jul 16, 2026 1:00 PM EDT

Register (Zoom): https://events.zoom.us/jv/Al_Jad5ZPgMnwgA9Fr4zmKWFKd-ACXZBWFcd2aoaOteYuD4bE2CR~AjfBgIGNNnF9yfdlwpYsr6yr-CEnfSYvIxZ6Wyl_-qDcGwR4cH5d-THA?lmt=1783535618000

Whenever you have a major shift in technology, there is always uncertainty. That's normal. AI is creating real changes in how assessments are performed, how vulnerabilities are discovered, and how organizations think about security. Those changes are going to impact careers, companies, and the services we provide.

But I don't believe this is the end of penetration testing.

Or do I?

Instead, I think we're entering a period where the complexity of modern environments is increasing faster than ever. AI can help defenders. AI can help attackers. AI can help pentesters. At the same time, it introduces entirely new risks, new attack paths, and new ways for organizations to make mistakes at scale.

Our industry has always been built around understanding and navigating complexity. That's what we do. As the environment becomes more complicated, the need for people who can think critically, adapt, and understand how systems actually fail becomes even more important.

Join me for a candid discussion about where AI is helping, where it's hurting, what we're doing at BHIS, and why I believe there is still plenty of opportunity ahead for security professionals willing to adapt.

I hope you'll join us, ask questions, challenge assumptions, and share what you're seeing as well.

Because if there's one thing I've learned in cybersecurity, it's that chaos is a ladder. And we're about to have plenty of opportunities to climb.

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